

DECODED EXPLAINED

27th July, 2026

Another Ship With 4 Indians Targeted at Ukraine Port, MEA Issues Advisory

Another ship with 4 Indians targeted at Ukraine port, MEA issues advisory

Two confirmed safe, information awaited on other two: Indian Embassy

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, July 26

IN THE third such incident in about a week, a merchant vessel with four Indians aboard came under attack at Ukraine's Odesa port on Saturday. While two seafarers are safe, information on the other two is still awaited, the Indian Embassy in Kyiv said on Sunday.

With five deaths of Indian seafarers in the region since July 18, India on Sunday issued an advisory urging its citizens to carefully assess the security situation before taking up jobs in maritime zones witnessing conflicts, especially in the Black Sea area.

The latest attack on the *MV AGN Ragnar* occurred at the Port of Odesa, one of Ukraine's key Black Sea ports that has been a frequent target of missile and drone attacks since the outbreak of the Russia-Ukraine conflict in 2022.

"Embassy of India in Ukraine is closely monitoring the situation following the incident involving *MV AGN Rag-*

THE WORLD PAGE 14



RUSSIA, UKRAINE
REPORT CIVILIANS
KILLED IN STRIKES

nar, which was struck at the Port of Odesa on July 25," the Indian Embassy said in a post on social media. "Four Indian nationals were on board the vessel. As per the latest information, two have been confirmed safe, and information is awaited regarding the other two nationals," it said.

Saying that search and rescue operations were underway, the Indian Embassy said it was in constant touch with the concerned authorities to ascertain the status of the missing crew members and extend all

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● The Latest Attack

- In the third such incident in about a week, a merchant vessel, MV AGN Ragnar, with four Indians aboard came under attack at Ukraine's Odesa port on Saturday, July 25
- Two seafarers are confirmed safe; information on the other two is still awaited, the Indian Embassy in Kyiv said
- Search and rescue operations were underway, with the Indian Embassy in constant touch with concerned authorities to ascertain the status of the missing crew members

● India's Advisory

- With five deaths of Indian seafarers in the region since July 18, India on Sunday issued an advisory urging its citizens to carefully assess the security situation before taking up jobs in maritime zones witnessing conflicts, especially in the Black Sea area
- The Port of Odessa, one of Ukraine's key Black Sea ports, has been a frequent target of missile and drone attacks since the outbreak of the Russia-Ukraine conflict in 2022

● Pattern of Attacks

- This is the third such incident targeting ships with Indian crew in about a week, following the earlier MV Golden Leo attack on July 19-20 that killed four Indians
- The repeated attacks highlight the escalating risk to merchant shipping and seafarers in the Black Sea region amid the ongoing war

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The Black Sea, also known as the Euxine Sea, is one of the major water bodies and a famous inland sea of the world.

This marginal sea of the Atlantic Ocean is located between Eastern Europe and Western Asia.

Land Boundary: The Black Sea is bordered by Ukraine to the north and northwest, Russia and Georgia to the east, Türkiye to the south, and Bulgaria and Romania to the west.



UKRAINE: THE JOURNEY TO INDEPENDENCE AND THE RUSSIA-UKRAINE CONFLICT

A STORY OF IDENTITY, FREEDOM & GEOPOLITICS



1 SOVIET UKRAINE (before 1985)

- Ukraine was one of the 15 republics of the Soviet Union.
- Moscow controlled politics, economy, language & military.
- Ukrainian identity suppressed; Russian language promoted (Russification).
- National feeling survived, but underground.

2 GORBACHEV'S REFORMS (1985-1989)

Perestroika (restructuring) & Glasnost (openness) opened space for people to speak up.

Society awakens

- Language & Culture
- History & Truth
- Religion Revival
- Environment
- Workers Protests

3 POLITICAL AWAKENING (1989-1991)

New organizations emerge:

- Ukrainian Helsinki Union
- Rukh (Popular Movement)

They demand: Democracy, Human rights, Sovereignty.

1990: First competitive elections
July 1990: Ukraine declares **SOVEREIGNTY** (Not yet independence)

4 INDEPENDENCE (1991)

AUG 1991 Hardline communists attempt a coup in Moscow. It fails.

AUG 24 Ukraine declares **INDEPENDENCE**.

DEC 1 Referendum: ~90% vote for independence.

DEC 1991 USSR collapses. Ukraine becomes an independent state.

Leonid Kravchuk becomes Ukraine's first President.

5 BUILDING A NEW NATION (1991-1999)

Achievements

- Own army
- Institutions built
- International recognition
- Pro-European foreign policy

Major Challenges

- NUCLEAR WEAPONS**
Inherited the world's 3rd largest arsenal. Agreed to give up nuclear weapons. Joined START treaty; received security assurances.
- CRIMEA QUESTION**
Majority Russian-speaking. Some want autonomy or union with Russia.
- BLACK SEA FLEET**
Dispute over Sevastopol & fleet. 1997 Agreement: Russia leases Sevastopol; Russia recognizes Ukraine's borders.

6 ECONOMIC HARDSHIPS (1990s)

- Hyperinflation
- Corruption
- Collapse of Soviet trade
- Dependence on Russian energy

Economic transition became extremely difficult.

7 POLITICAL DIVISIONS (1994-2004)

WESTERN UKRAINE (Ukrainian-speaking)

- Pro-Europe
- National identity strong

EASTERN UKRAINE (Russian-speaking)

- Pro-Russia
- Closer cultural & economic ties with Russia

This east-west divide shapes Ukrainian politics.

8 ORANGE REVOLUTION (2004)

- Election between Viktor Yanukovich (pro-Russia) & Viktor Yushchenko (pro-Europe).
- Election fraud sparks massive protests (Orange Revolution).
- Supreme Court cancels election; re-election held.
- Yushchenko wins.

Democracy strengthened; Ukraine moves closer to Europe.

9 YANUKOVYCH RETURNS (2010)

- Yanukovich becomes President.
- Improves ties with Russia.
- Extends Russia's lease in Sevastopol.
- Suspends plans for NATO membership.

Public dissatisfaction grows.

10 EUROMAIDAN PROTESTS (2013-2014)

- Yanukovich cancels EU Association Agreement under Russian pressure.
- Mass protests erupt in Kyiv (Maidan).
- Government responds with violence; hundreds killed.
- Yanukovich flees.
- Parliament removes him.

Interim government formed.

11 CRIMEA ANNEXATION (2014)

- Russia claims to protect Russian speakers.
- Russian troops occupy Crimea.
- Controversial referendum held.
- Russia annexes Crimea.

Illegal annexation rejected by Ukraine & most countries.

12 WAR IN DONBAS (2014-2021)

- Pro-Russian separatists seize parts of Donetsk & Luhansk.
- Ukraine fights back.
- Russia denies direct involvement but supports separatists.
- Minsk Agreements (2014, 2015) signed for ceasefire.
- Fighting never fully stops; conflict becomes "frozen".

Thousands killed; millions affected.

13 ZELENSKY ELECTED (2019)

- Former comedian & actor.
- Wins election on promises of fighting corruption & ending the war.
- Peace efforts continue, but limited success.

Hope for change.

14 FULL-SCALE RUSSIAN INVASION (2022)

- Russia massed ~190,000 troops on Ukraine's borders.
- Demands: NATO not expand; stop arming Ukraine.
- Negotiations fail.
- Russia launches full-scale invasion.
- Objectives: Capture Kyiv, topple government, control Ukraine.

Ukraine resists; Russia fails to capture Kyiv & major cities.

15 ONGOING IMPACT (2022-PRESENT)

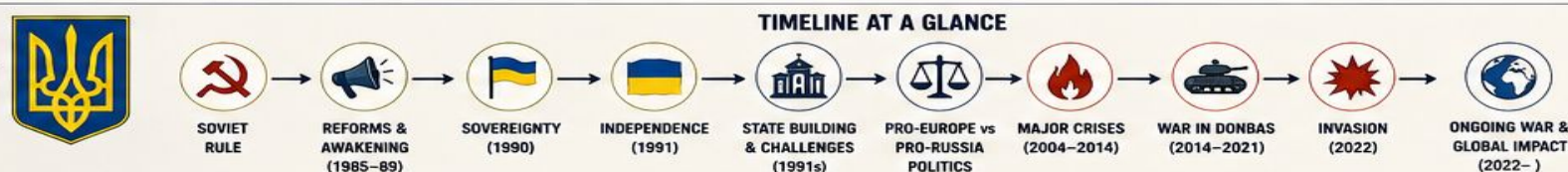
HUMANITARIAN
Millions of refugees; thousands of civilians killed; allegations of war crimes.

INTERNATIONAL
Massive sanctions on Russia; large-scale military aid to Ukraine.

GEOPOLITICAL SHIFT
Finland & Sweden joined NATO; Ukraine granted EU candidate status; global alignment shifts.

THE BIGGER PICTURE

Ukraine's struggle is not just about territory—it is about the right to choose its own future, preserve its identity, and live in freedom. It is a conflict between democracy & authoritarianism, sovereignty & aggression.



KEY TAKEAWAY

From a suppressed nation under the Soviet Union to an independent state fighting for its sovereignty—Ukraine's journey is a powerful story of resilience, courage and the quest for freedom.

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Colour Revolutions:

About: It refers to peaceful, mass protest uprisings in post-Soviet states, characterized by symbolic colours, aiming to replace pro-Moscow regimes with peaceful and democratic governments.

Though initially successful in creating pro-Western governments, these revolutions often resulted in instability, corruption, and disillusionment.

Georgia's Rose Revolution (2003)

Ukraine's Orange Revolution (2004)

Kyrgyzstan's Tulip Revolution (2005)

Euromaidan: Leading to the Crimean crisis

The Euromaidan was a wave of demonstrations, civil unrest, and revolution in Ukraine, which began on the night of 21 November 2013 with public protests demanding closer European integration.

In February and March 2014, Russia invaded the Crimean Peninsula, part of Ukraine, and then annexed it. This took place in the relative power vacuum immediately following the Revolution of Dignity. It marked the beginning of the Russo-Ukrainian war.

Minsk Agreement refers to the 2014 and 2015 peace accords aimed at ending the eastern Ukraine conflict. These agreements were negotiated by: Ukraine, Russia, OSCE (Organization for Security and Cooperation in Europe), Separatist representatives of Donetsk and Luhansk

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Q. Consider the following pairs:

Area of conflict mentioned in news	Country where it is located
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1.Donbas	Syria
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2.Kachin	Ethiopia
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3.Tigray	North Yemen
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How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

[A] Only one

[B] Only two

[C] All three

[D] None

Need to Shift Focus to Rising Student Suicides, Cost of Education

Need to shift focus to rising student suicides, cost of education

As the protests led by the CJP end, larger systemic issues associated with high-stakes entrance examinations such as NEET need to be addressed

DATA POINT

Sambavi Parthasarathy

The sustained protests led by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) demanding accountability over paper leaks in the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET) came to an end on Saturday with the government accepting many of their demands, including the resignation of Union Minister of Education Dharmendra Pradhan, compensation for the families of the deceased who ended their lives over the NEET paper leaks, and the withdrawal of criminal cases against protesters.

Thousands of protesters who gathered across many places in the country despite crackdown by the government, including brutal police action in Delhi on July 20, have termed Mr. Pradhan's resignation a 'historic win'. While their demands have successfully pinned accountability for a leaked question paper, larger questions around high-stakes entrance exams – the NEET in particular – such as the proliferation of coaching centres, increased expenditure for families, and high levels of stress experienced by students, remain unaddressed.

Over 20 lakh students appeared for NEET in the first week of May. Reports indicate that more than a dozen students died by suicide after the exam was cancelled and rescheduled due to widespread allegations of question papers getting leaked. These suicides cannot be seen in isolation. The number of student suicides increased by about 80% from 8,068 in 2014 to 14,488 in 2024, the latest year for which the *Accidental Deaths and Suicides in India (ADSI)* report by the *National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB)* has been published.

Over 1.23 lakh students ended their lives between 2014 and 2024 in the country (**Chart 1**).

The Ministry of Education stated in Parliament that suicides

among students are driven by various causes such as academic stress, family problems, mental health issues, financial distress and interpersonal conflicts. The ADSI reports capture "failure in examination" as a distinct category of reason for suicides. Suicides for which "failure in examination" was the primary reason accounted for 21%, or more than one-fifth, of the total number of student suicides between 2014 and 2024. Over 2,000 students died every year due to failure in examinations, with 2021 being the only exception. Cumulatively, over 25,000 students died by suicide due to failure in exams between 2014 and 2024, of which 55% were under 18 years and another 42% between 18 and 30 years of age (**Chart 2**).

Though student suicides cannot be seen in the context of NEET alone, this highly competitive medical entrance exam has come to symbolise these systemic issues. The exam has repeatedly come under focus for issues such as paper leaks, inhumane levels of checking of students while entering exam halls, and concerns over unusually high-scoring patterns from select centres. Over 15 lakh students have registered for the NEET examination every year since 2015. However, those who made it to the pool of qualified candidates is less than 57% (**Chart 3**).

Moreover, the need to join private coaching and the reality that many have to repeat the exam after studying for another year or two to qualify have contributed to significant costs for households. More than 35% of secondary and higher secondary students attend private coaching. In fact, households' private coaching expenses is about a third of their entire education expenditure (**Chart 4**).

While the protests have come to an end, at least temporarily, these systemic problems await closure.

(Assistance for overcoming suicidal thoughts is available on TeleMANAS 14416 and Sneha's suicide prevention helpline 044-24640050)

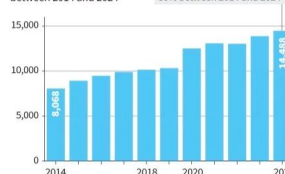


Under pressure

The data for the charts were sourced from the National Testing Agency's press releases, the *Accidental Deaths and Suicides in India (ADSI)* reports, and *Comprehensive Modular survey: Education 2025 (CMS:E 2025)*

Carrying the flame: Supporters lighting candles to pay homage to the students who died by suicide after the NEET paper leak during the third day of protests by the Cockroach Janta Party, at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi on June 22. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA / THE HINDU

Chart 1: Number of students who died by suicide between 2014 and 2024



The number of students who died by suicide increased by 80% between 2014 and 2024

Chart 2: Age-wise split of persons who died by suicide due to 'Failure in Examination'

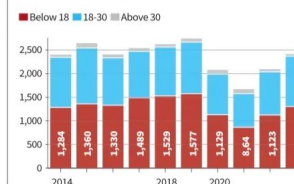
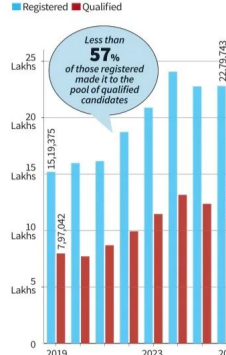


Chart 3: Number of students who registered for NEET and number of students who qualified



With inputs from Gauri Singavarapu, Gandia Sneha, and Sachin Swaraj who are interning with The Hindu Data Team

Chart 4a: Share of students (in %) who were taking/had taken private coaching during an academic year as per CMS:E 2025 at different levels of enrolment

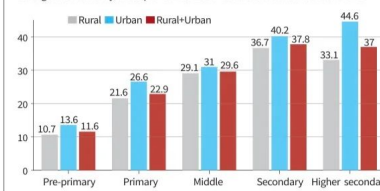
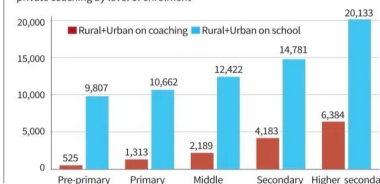


Chart 4b: Average expenditure (₹) per student on school education and private coaching by level of enrolment



Need to Shift Focus to Rising Student Suicides, Cost of Education

- **The Scale of Student Suicides**

- **The number of student suicides increased by about 80%, from 8,068 in 2014 to 14,488 in 2024, per NCRB's Accidental Deaths and Suicides in India report; over 1.23 lakh students ended their lives between 2014 and 2024**

- **The Road Ahead**

- While the protests have come to an end, at least temporarily, these systemic problems, the coaching culture, exam-linked stress, and the cost burden on families, await closure

Need to Shift Focus to Rising Student Suicides, Cost of Education

Positive Impact

Education Access

Digital Learning

Regional Hubs

Negative Impact

Knowledge Gap

Stress Epidemic

Inequality Divide

Way Forward

School Upgrade

Exam Reform

Coaching Oversight

Equity Access

“Coaching can open doors, but true learning builds minds.” India must ensure access, equity, and holistic education to empower every student’s potential.

PRAXIS: Grazing Planet Rings

PRAXIS: grazing planet rings

Vasudevan Mukunth

PRAXIS is an acronym of 'Planetary Rings Autonomous EXploration with In-situ Sampling'. NASA has just selected a mission concept called 'PRAXIS' for its Innovative Advanced Concepts (NIAC) 2026 phase I funding.

The mission will consist of a bio-inspired robotic explorer driven by an artificial intelligence (AI) model. It will be capable of directly sampling particles from planetary ring systems — something no mission has ever attempted before. The mission's selection for NIAC was guided by open questions in the science of planets' rings that NASA's Planetary Science Decadal Survey has flagged as important.

These questions include how planetary rings form, how they evolve, and what ring particles are made of.

Rather than fly through a ring — which would pose collision hazards — PRAXIS currently plans to just graze the ring plane. Specifically, once it has picked a target particle, the spacecraft will perform a touch-and-go sample of the particle's surface using a long deployable boom, staying at a safe distance from the moving ring particles. Once it has a sample, the craft will move on to another region or gap in the rings to sample from another area.

When it has a sample, small instruments will snag free-floating particles and the



James Webb Space Telescope's view of Saturn's atmosphere. SPACE TELESCOPE SCIENCE INSTITUTE/NASA

AI model will help measure particle size, porosity, and composition. Being selected for NIAC phase-I finding means the PRAXIS team can start running simulations and studying system design. If the idea advances to phase II, the team can start building a physical prototype. According to its developers, the PRAXIS sampling system can be used in missions to study many ringed planets.



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PRAXIS: Grazing Planet Rings

- **The Mission Concept**

- **PRAXIS, an acronym for 'Planetary Rings Autonomous EXploration with In-situ Sampling', is a mission concept NASA has just selected for its Innovative Advanced Concepts (NIAC) 2026 Phase I funding**

- The mission will consist of a bio-inspired robotic explorer driven by an artificial intelligence model, capable of directly sampling particles from planetary ring systems, something no mission has ever attempted before

- **Why This Matters Scientifically**

- The mission's selection for NIAC was guided by open questions in the science of planetary rings that NASA's Planetary Science Decadal Survey has flagged as important, including how planetary rings form, how they evolve, and what ring particles are made of

Do Not Surrender to China, Do Not Depend on the U.S.

Do not surrender to China, do not depend on the U.S.

A volatile political climate in Washington has triggered a wave of strategic anxiety in New Delhi. Buffeted by the transactional, often erratic policy shifts of the Donald Trump administration – which hit India last year with punitive tariffs on steel and aluminium, stripped its preferential trade status, and aggressively renewed ties with Islamabad while imposing irritants such as tightening H-1B visa rules – a growing chorus of domestic voices is calling for a fundamental reset of India's China policy.

Economic actors, their flawed line

The argument, championed largely by an influential business lobby, suggests that India's confrontational approach toward Beijing was overly synchronised with Washington's strategic agenda of "containment" rather than India's national interests. The lobby contends that because India remains deeply reliant on Chinese technology, supply chains, industrial inputs, and capital, a dogmatic anti-China stance ultimately stymies domestic economic growth while barely denting Beijing's economy. The core risk, critics warn, is Washington's historical pattern of tactical flip-flops – escalating tensions one day and striking bilateral deals the next – which risks leaving an overextended India strategically vulnerable to Chinese retaliation.

While the warning against subordinating Indian interests to an unpredictable Washington is entirely valid, it is not clear that this is what is occurring. In any case, the proposed alternative – a hasty, unreciprocated economic embrace of China – is a dangerous prescription. It mistakes tactical business convenience for long-term national security. A premature capitulation to Beijing ignores a decade of unprovoked hostility, deepens an asymmetric dependency, and strips India of its leverage just as the global order enters its most volatile phase since the Cold War.

Let us face it: the primary domestic driver for a China reset is an influential business lobby obsessed with short-term balance sheets. For years, parts of corporate India have argued that access to cheap Chinese capital, machinery, and active pharmaceutical ingredients (APIs) is indispensable for India's growth. However, this view suffers from severe strategic myopia. It treats international trade as an apolitical transaction, completely divorced from the realities of comprehensive national power.

By advocating a return to the pre-2020 status quo, these economic actors choose to selectively forget a dozen years of relentless, unprovoked aggression by the People's Liberation Army (PLA) and the Chinese Communist Party (CCP). The list of Beijing's hostile acts against Indian sovereignty is not a series of isolated border skirmishes; it is a coherent strategy of containment and



Shashi Tharoor

Fourth-term Member of Parliament (Lok Sabha) for Thiruvananthapuram (Congress party), the Chairman of the Parliamentary Standing Committee on External Affairs and the Sahitya Akademi Award-winning author of 29 books, including 'Pax Indica' (2012) and 'The New World Disorder' (2020)

Realising that Washington is an unreliable partner does not mean India must run into the arms of an actively hostile neighbour

humiliation. From Dipsang (2013) and Chumar (2014) to Doklam (2017) and then the fatal clashes in the Galwan Valley (2020), China has systematically attempted to alter the Line of Actual Control (LAC) through salami-slicing tactics, unilaterally violating decades of border peace protocols. Beijing continues to aggressively assert absurd claims over the entire State of Arunachal Pradesh, renaming geographical features in places it does not control (but plans to), and issuing stapled visas to residents of Jammu and Kashmir and Arunachal to weaponise India's internal geography.

And then there is economic coercion. China has routinely used its manufacturing dominance as a political weapon, abruptly withholding critical machinery and industrial inputs, even weaponising its monopoly over rare earths and tunnel-boring machines during bilateral disputes, simply to inconvenience Indian industries and signal its leverage, knowing fully that India has none to exercise in return. Most alarming has been Beijing's overt, coordinated military support for Pakistan during Operation Sindoor (May 2025). By providing Islamabad with real-time tactical satellite data and intelligence, China transformed itself from a mere military supplier into an active, hostile participant in Pakistan's security architecture against India. To ignore this track record in pursuit of cheaper components is not pragmatism; it is strategic blindness.

The myth of reciprocity

The core flaw in the argument for a quick reset is the naive assumption that if India relaxes its economic guard, China will reciprocate with geopolitical goodwill. The foundational tenet of Chinese foreign policy in Asia is the establishment of a unipolar continent. Beijing does not view New Delhi as a peer, nor does it desire India to become one.

For over a decade, China has weaponised its veto at the United Nations Security Council (UNSC) to shield Pakistan-based terrorist organisations from international sanctions and condemnation. It has blocked India's legitimate aspirations for permanent membership in the UNSC and membership in the Nuclear Suppliers Group (NSG). If India opens the floodgates to Chinese capital and market access without any fundamental resolution of the border dispute or a halt to Beijing's hostile behaviour, it effectively subsidises its own encirclement. Pouring billions of dollars into Chinese coffers as a compliant consumer market merely expands the asymmetric trade deficit (China's annual surplus over India now exceeds \$100 billion). More dangerously, it hands Beijing an economic kill-switch over the Indian economy. In a future crisis, the threat of cutting off critical components could paralyse Indian industry,

rendering New Delhi incapable of independent strategic decision-making.

Advocates of a reset argue that easing economic tensions could pave the way for a permanent demarcation of the border. In reality, the opposite is true. China respects power and exploits vulnerability. If India surrenders its economic leverage and signals that it cannot sustain a prolonged stand-off, Beijing will conclude that its strategy of multi-domain pressure is working. China will simply bide its time, allowing India to grow comfortably dependent once again. When Beijing eventually decides it is ready to discuss a permanent border settlement, it will dictate terms from a position of absolute dominance. An India structurally dependent on Chinese technology and cowed by the threat of economic disruption will have no choice but to accept a deeply disadvantageous territorial status quo.

Leverage, once surrendered, cannot be easily reclaimed. The restrictions India placed on Chinese apps, investments, and telecom infrastructure post-Galwan were not just emotional reactions; they were crucial diplomatic leverage. Dismantling them for minor economic relief would be an act of unilateral disarmament.

India is undeniably in a complex position. The Trump administration's unpredictable shifts mean that relying entirely on Washington as a security guarantor is unwise, despite the enthusiasm of his emissary to India, Sergio Goro. The United States will always prioritise its own domestic and global calculations, and New Delhi must remain clear-eyed that it stands alone on the heights of Ladakh. However, realising that Washington is an unreliable partner does not mean India must run into the arms of an actively hostile neighbour. There is an immense strategic space between subordinating India's national interests to the U.S. and conceding an unconditional economic and political surrender to China.

The path India must tread

The correct path for New Delhi is one of strategic patience and internal fortifying. India must accelerate its supply chain resilience, diversify its trade partnerships across Europe, East Asia, and the Global South, and aggressively build up its domestic manufacturing capabilities – even if it comes with short-term inflationary costs. The last decade has proven that China presents a structural, generational challenge to India's rise. A hasty rethink driven by panic over Washington or the complaints of a short-term-profit-driven business lobby will only ensure that India remains permanently exposed, economically vulnerable, and strategically diminished.

We do not have to "tilt" either way. We must, instead, develop the strength to walk straight.

Do Not Surrender to China, Do Not Depend on the U.S.

● The Debate Triggered

- A volatile political climate in Washington, driven by the Trump administration's transactional and often erratic policy shifts, including punitive tariffs on Indian steel and aluminium, stripped preferential trade status, renewed ties with Islamabad, and tightened H-1B visa rules, has triggered a wave of strategic anxiety in New Delhi, with a growing chorus of domestic voices calling for a fundamental reset of India's China policy
- An influential business lobby argues India's confrontational approach toward Beijing was overly synchronised with Washington's containment agenda rather than India's own national interests, contending that continued reliance on Chinese technology, supply chains, and capital means a dogmatic anti-China stance stymies domestic growth while barely denting Beijing's economy

● Opinion of Shashi Tharoor

- The author argues that while caution against subordinating Indian interests to an unpredictable Washington is valid, the proposed alternative, a hasty, unreciprocated economic embrace of China, is a dangerous prescription that ignores a decade of unprovoked hostility and strips India of leverage
- China has systematically attempted to alter the Line of Actual Control through salami-slicing tactics, from Depsang (2013) and Chumar (2014) to Doklam (2017) and the fatal Galwan Valley clashes (2020), while asserting claims over Arunachal Pradesh and issuing stapled visas to residents of Jammu and Kashmir and Arunachal
- China has also used economic coercion, withholding critical machinery and industrial inputs and weaponizing its monopoly over rare earths and tunnel-boring machines during disputes, and provided overt, coordinated military support to Pakistan during Operation Sindoor in May 2025, including real-time tactical satellite data and intelligence

Do Not Surrender to China, Do Not Depend on the U.S.

● 'The Myth of Reciprocity'

○ The core flaw in the argument for a quick reset is the naive assumption that if India relaxes its economic guard, China will reciprocate with geopolitical goodwill; Beijing's foundational tenet is establishing a unipolar continent and it does not view New Delhi as a peer

● The Path India Must Tread

○ The correct path is strategic patience and internal fortifying, accelerating supply chain resilience, diversifying trade partnerships across Europe, East Asia, and the Global South, and aggressively building domestic manufacturing capabilities, even at short-term inflationary cost

○ India need not 'tilt' either way between the US and China; realising Washington is an unreliable partner does not mean running into the arms of an actively hostile neighbour

Thank You